

Game Design Document: The Intercessor's Lamp

Version: 1.0

Platform: Meta Quest 3S (Standalone)

Engine: Unity (URP)

Genre: Mixed Reality (MR) Defense / Spiritual Simulation

Target Audience: Ages 13–45 (Christian Gamers, Youth Groups, Tech-Forward Believers)

1. Executive Summary

- The Intercessor's Lamp is a Mixed Reality spiritual warfare game where players turn their physical living room into a spiritual battleground. The player acts as a "Watchman," tasked with protecting a weary spiritual pilgrim (The Traveler) from encroaching "Shadows" (Lies, Fear, Anxiety).
- Unlike traditional shooters, the player cannot win by fighting alone. They must balance active combat (speaking Scripture, blocking attacks) with spiritual discipline (retreating to an Altar to read the Bible and refill their "Oil"). The game culminates in a narrative twist revealing that the intercession was not just for others, but for the player's own soul.

2. Core Pillars

- Abide to Protect: You cannot pour from an empty cup. Combat drains your "Oil"; reading Scripture refills it. Balancing these two is the core loop.
- Your Room, Your Battlefield: Using the Quest 3S Passthrough, the spiritual battle happens in the player's real environment, grounding abstract theological concepts in reality.
- Spoken Authority: Voice activation is the primary weapon. Players must speak Truth to dispel Lies.
- Community as Fuel: A VR social hub ("The Encampment") connects players for prayer and encouragement before they enter their solo MR missions.

3. Gameplay Mechanics

A. The Setup (Mixed Reality)

- The Traveler: An NPC placed on the player's real furniture (couch/chair).
- The Altar: A virtual station placed on a surface away from the Traveler.
- The Veil: A dark fog shrouding the Traveler. As the player succeeds, the fog lifts.

B. The Loop: Fight / Drain / Refill

- The Attack: Shadows emerge from real-world walls targeting the Traveler.
- The Defense: Shield of Faith (Hand Tracking/Controller): Physically raising a hand creates a barrier to block projectiles ("Darts"). Durability is tied to Oil levels.
- Sword of the Spirit (Voice): Shadows whisper lies via Spatial Audio (e.g., "They are worthless"). The player must identify the lie and speak the counter-verse (e.g., "They are fearfully made!") to banish the Shadow.
- The Drain: Every shield block and spoken verse consumes Oil.
- The Refill: When Oil is low, the player must physically turn away from the battle, walk to the Altar, and read a displayed Bible passage aloud.

- Tension: While reading, the player cannot see the Traveler, only hear the battle intensifying behind them.

C. Abilities & Spiritual Gifts

- Intercessory Prayer (Active): Kneeling by the Traveler and touching their shoulder creates a temporary "Dome of Grace" (invincibility), buying time to run to the Altar.
- Worship (Ultimate): Raising both hands and singing/shouting praise triggers a blast of light, stunning all enemies and clearing the room. High Oil cost.
- Discernment (Passive): Highlights the specific "Lie" a Shadow is carrying so the player knows which Verse to use.

4. Narrative & Progression: "The Lifting of the Veil"

A. Phase 0: The Book of Remembrance (Tutorial/Survey)

- Setting: A quiet void.
- Interaction: A diegetic book asks the player to input names of real people they care about (e.g., "A friend in need," "A family member," "A personal struggle").
- Tech: Strings are stored locally to populate future levels.

B. Phase 1: The Stranger (Acts 1-3)

- Traveler: A generic biblical figure.
- Goal: Learn the mechanics.
- Visuals: Traveler is 100% shrouded in black smoke.
- Outcome: Veil lifts to reveal a historic martyr or disciple.

C. Phase 2: The Friend (Acts 4-6)

- Traveler: A generic modern human model, but the HUD identifies them using the "Friend" name from the Survey.
- Enemy Logic: Shadows whisper specific lies regarding friendship and loyalty.
- Visuals: Traveler is 50% shrouded (gray fog).

D. Phase 3: The Blood (Acts 7-9)

- Traveler: Represents the "Family Member" from the Survey.
- Difficulty: High. Shadows attack the Altar (distracting the player from the Word).
- Visuals: Traveler is 25% shrouded.

E. Phase 4: The Mirror (The Climax)

- Traveler: Huddled, weeping, 90% shrouded again.
- Enemy Logic: Shadows attack the Player directly with the "Personal Struggle" input from the Survey.
- The Reveal: Upon final cleansing, the Traveler turns around. It is an avatar of the player.
- Theme: "Love your neighbor as yourself."

5. The Encampment (Multiplayer Hub)

- Mode: Fully Immersive VR (Not MR).
- Setting: A desert campfire under a night sky.
- The Prayer Wall: Players leave sticky notes with prayer requests. Interacting with a note sends a "Prayer Notification" to the writer.
- The Fire: Proximity voice chat. Players can sit and talk.

- The Armory: Players can "equip" verses. Unlocking a verse in single-player makes it available to "share" here as a buff for others.

6. Characters & Enemy Types

A. Allies

- The Traveler: Passive. Health is represented by "Inner Light."
- The Guide (Voice): A calm, non-physical audio guide (The Holy Spirit archetype) providing hints and encouragement.

B. Enemies (The Shadows)

- The Whisperer: Floats near walls. Whispers lies. Must be defeated by Voice (Scripture).
- The Accuser: Throws fiery darts. Must be blocked by Shield.
- The Bramble: Grows over the Altar, preventing reading. Must be cleared by "laying on hands" (physically wiping it away).
- The Goliath: A Boss type. Requires a combination of Worship (Stun) and Word (Damage) to defeat.

7. Audio & Visual Style

A. Visual Style

- MR Elements: High-fidelity particle effects (Light vs. Smoke) overlaid on the real world.
- UI: Diegetic. Health/Oil is displayed on a wrist-watch style interface or a floating holographic ring on the player's hand. No screen-space HUDs.
- Shader Tech: "Veil Shader" that transitions from opaque black smoke to transparent glowing light.

B. Audio Design

- Spatial Audio: Crucial. Enemies must be locatable by sound alone (Quest 3S HRTF).
- Whispers: Glitchy, reversed reverb, harsh.
- Scripture/Worship: Clear, resonant, harmonic.
- Music: Adaptive. Chaotic/Dissonant during battle; swells to Orchestral/Choral when the Traveler is cleansed.

8. Technical Requirements (Meta Quest 3S)

A. Hardware Features

- Passthrough API: For main gameplay.
- Scene Understanding (MRUK): To detect walls (spawn points) and tables (Altar placement).
- Hand Tracking 2.2: For gestures (Shield, Prayer).
- Microphone: Active listening for Voice SDK.

B. Software Stack

- Unity Version: 2022.3 LTS or Unity 6.
- Meta XR All-in-One SDK: Core interaction.
- Wit.ai (Meta Voice SDK): For Intent recognition (Speech-to-Action).
- Photon Fusion or Normcore: For Multiplayer Hub networking.

9. Accessibility & Safety

- Physical: "Seated Mode" option for players with limited mobility (brings Altar and Traveler closer).
- Emotional: "Cool Down" button in the menu immediately pauses the battle and switches to a calm worship environment if the player feels overwhelmed.
- Privacy: All Survey data is stored locally in PlayerPrefs or JSON on the headset. It is never transmitted to a server.

10. Future Roadmap (DLC/Updates)

- Co-op Missions: Two players in the same physical room (Shared Spatial Anchor) defending one Traveler.
- Scripture Packs: New "Ammunition" based on different books of the Bible (e.g., The Psalms Pack, The Proverbs Pack).
- Global Prayer Events: Synchronized events in "The Encampment."